

The "Violent Override" in CSS Layout Tracks

Algorithmic conflict: Why an unconstrained 4000px image shatters a 300px Grid Column

1. The CSS Developer's Intent

```
/* Define a strict 300px sidebar */
.grid-container {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: 300px 1fr;
}
/* No constraints placed on the image */
.sidebar img { }
```

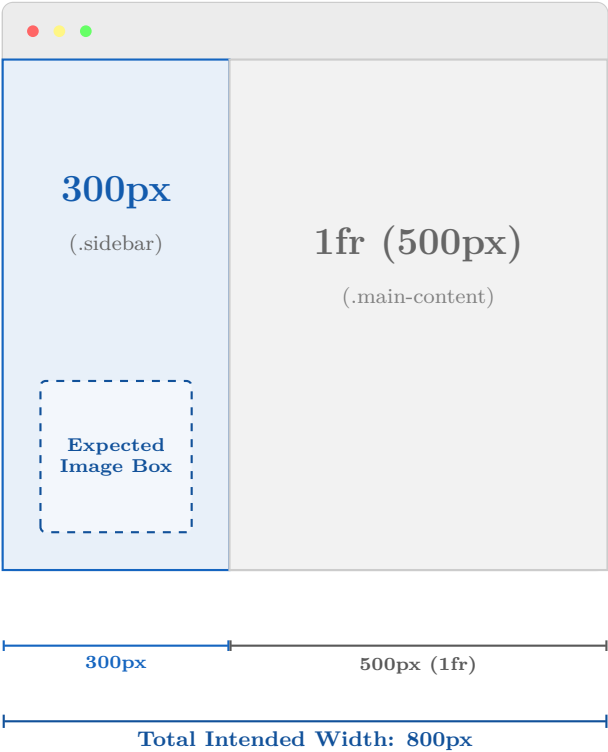
2. The Devastating Layout Reality

 **The CSS Grid / Flex Minimums Rule**

By default, grid items do not shrink below their minimum content size (`min-width: auto`).
For Replaced Elements (images), `auto` resolves directly to their **physical intrinsic size** (4000px).

The layout engine calculates:
"Track 1 is commanded to be 300px, BUT its minimum required content size is 4000px. Because content prevents data loss by default, the track MUST violently expand to 4000px!"

Intended Viewport / Grid Container (800px wide)



Inject raw binary

(4000 × 3000 px)



Visible Viewport Window (800px) - User must now scroll

